

Security incident report

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Section 1: Identify the network protocol involved in the incident

The network protocol used in this incident is port 80 which is used for browsers to access websites and is an unencrypted connection.

Section 2: Document the incident

multiple customers emailed yummyrecipesforme's helpdesk. They complained that the company's website had prompted them to download a file to access free recipes. They also mentioned that after downloading the recipes their computers were running slow. The security team deployed a sandbox environment to observe the suspicious website behavior. This is what the logs revealed:

1. The browser initiates a DNS request: It requests the IP address of the yummyrecipesforme.com URL from the DNS server.
2. The DNS replies with the correct IP address.
3. The browser initiates an HTTP request: It requests the yummyrecipesforme.com webpage using the IP address sent by the DNS server.
4. The browser initiates the download of the malware.
5. The browser initiates a DNS request for greatrecipesforme.com.
6. The DNS server responds with the IP address for greatrecipesforme.com.
7. The browser initiates an HTTP request to the IP address for greatrecipesforme.com.

This attack is called a brute force attack where someone guesses the password to the website host and embedded some malicious code on the website.

Section 3: Recommend one remediation for brute force attacks

Password policy needs to be put in place so that this kind of attack can be avoided. This may include changing the password at least once in 2 months. Or a password with one Capital letter, one digit, a character and not less than 8 characters in length.